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TOBA BATAK RELATIONSHIP TERMINOLOGY¹

The aim of this article is to provide a complete and accurate description of the Toba Batak relationship terminology, verify its important features (patrilineality, an asymmetric (matrilateral) prescription, and the requirement of five lines to adequately represent the terminology), and analyze the application of its principles of classification (genealogical level, alliance status, sex, relative age, and order of marriage) and the relationship among them. Based on data collected in Medan over a three-year period, both men's and women's terms of reference and address are examined and it is argued that the pervasiveness of alternation and its articulation with patrilineality and asymmetry appear to be exceptional. Comparisons are drawn with other asymmetric terminologies, including those from eastern Indonesia and that of the Karo Batak, the most closely related group for which the record is relatively complete.

Based on Neumann (1866), Ypes (1932), and Vergouwen (1964), Needham maintains that the Toba Batak have an asymmetric prescriptive terminology (Needham 1962:52-54; 1966a:1265-1268; 1971:lxii-lxiv). Descriptions of the terminology by Cunningham (1958), Ihromi (1963), and Fischer (1966) are inadequate because they fail to clearly distinguish terms of reference from terms of address, and terms by a male speaker from those of a female speaker. It is intended that this article will fill the need for a comprehensive analysis.

Previous studies of Toba Batak terminology are incomplete because women's terms are rarely given, and their genealogical specifications are often deficient. The collection of women's terms is critical because "the woman has a role of fundamental importance in the social organization (and conceptual order) of a radically different kind from the male, at least in asymmetric systems" (Barnes 1973:80). In spite of their acknowledged importance, there have been few systematic studies of women's terminologies, with the exceptions of Barnes (1974) and Forth (1981). It will be shown that the women's terms are necessary in order to

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obtain a complete understanding of the relationships among the Toba Batak principles of classification.

The importance of genealogical level as a principle of classification will be shown to be reduced by the application of many terms to more than one level, and alliance status will be shown to be emphasized by the distinction of wife-givers and wife-takers in several ways. This represents a simplification of classification along the lineal dimension and an elaboration of the lateral dimension, the two possible dimensions of classification outlined by Needham (1969:165). It will be shown that corresponding simplification along the lateral dimension which, according to Barnes (1979:27), involves the equivalence of affines of opposed kinds, also occurs in the Toba Batak terminology but not nearly to the same extent. In general, alliance status distinctions are maintained.

What is striking about the Toba Batak terminology is not that terms are applied on different levels, because this is also characteristic of the terminologies of Purum (Needham 1962:76), Kachin (Leach 1965:41), Endeh (Needham 1968:322), Pantar (Barnes 1973:77), Alor Besar (Barnes 1973:80), and Kédang (Barnes 1974:271). Nor is its use of lineal equivalence to emphasize alliance status unique, since this also occurs elsewhere (cf. Barnes 1979:26). While it is true that the Toba Batak terminology is unusual because, like that of the Gurage (Needham 1969:155), it makes equivalences not only in external lines but also in the line of reference, this is not its major significance. It will be demonstrated that the Toba Batak terminology makes an apparently unique exploitation of the lineal dimension of classification in the extent to which it ignores distinctions of genealogical level and combines alternate generations to reinforce alliance status, raising wife-givers and lowering wife-takers.

The application of terms to more than one level by combining alternate generations in the Toba Batak terminology represents a pervasive use of "the principle of combination of alternate generations" first suggested by Radcliffe-Brown (1956b:69). Dumont also speaks of "a universal tendency to group together alternate generations" (Dumont 1966:238). The apparent equivalence of Toba Batak terms for grandparent and grandchild, which verifies this principle, is supported by the association of terms for second ascending and second descending generations in Rindi (Forth 1981), Endeh (Needham 1968), Tanebar-Evav (Barraud 1979), Manggarai (Needham 1966b; Gordon 1980), and Alor Besar (Barnes 1973). This terminological equivalence is related to ideas about the relationship between grandparents and grandchildren. Dumont notes, with reference to Australian systems, "the ubiquity of features which bring together, in terminology as well as behaviour, grandparents and grandchildren" (Dumont 1966:238) and the tie of friendly equality between grandparents and grandchildren is attributed

by Radcliffe-Brown to the fact that grandchildren are considered to replace their grandparents (Radcliffe-Brown 1952a:96). Forth notes that the "governing idea is that members of the second descending level assume the names and, in a sense, the identities of individuals in the second ascending level" (Forth 1981:323). In Kédang terminology and thought, Barnes finds a continuum from the living, through the aged, to the ancestors (Barnes 1974; 1979:26).

The categorically relevant distinctions of both genealogical level and alliance status must be marked, in contrast to the distinction of relative age which in certain cases may be modified or ignored in the Toba Batak terminology. Needham sees the relationship between relative age and category as a source of socially recognized contradiction which must be dealt with, and emphasizes that there often are alternatives to the terms imposed by genealogy and ways to avoid or change the categorical relations (Needham 1974:74-75).

The remainder of the article begins with a brief discussion of ethnographic background, followed by a description of Toba Batak terms of reference and address. The third and fourth sections contain an analysis of men's and women's reference terms which verify the major features of the terminology. An analysis of terms of address follows, with particular attention to the varied use of the terms *amang* and *inang*, and address by name, teknonymy, and clan name. The next section treats the principles of classification exhibited by the terminology and concludes with a discussion of how the pattern of alternate generations reinforces alliance status, based on correspondences between the men's and women's terminologies. Concluding remarks are made concerning the implication of the findings for the analysis of asymmetric prescriptive terminologies.

Ethnographic Background

The Toba Batak, one of six Batak groups (Toba, Karo, Simalungun, Pak-pak – Dairi, Mandailing, and Angkola – Sipirok) which originate in contiguous areas of highland Sumatra, comprise a population of about one million.² The city of Medan has long been a focus of migration, and the Toba Batak population there is currently estimated at nearly 200,000 (Pelly 1982). We know that urban Toba Batak maintain extensive and regular contacts with kin in the homeland, and that their social system has survived intact in the city (Bruner 1959, 1973).

Toba Batak society is ordered by patrilineal descent and asymmetric alliance. There are several hundred clans (*marga*), but the corporate unit of marriage exchange is a localized patrilineage (also *marga*). Incorporation into clans is usually by birth, but non-Batak wives may be adopted. Each clan traces its origin to Si Raja Batak, the mythical ancestor of all Bataks, a distance of fifteen to twenty-five generations. Marriage is asymmetrical, prescribed with the category *pariban* (which includes a man's MBD and a woman's FZS) and prohibited with a man's FZD and

a woman's MBS, who are classified as *iboto*, or siblings. Wife-givers (*hulahula*) are distinguished from wife-takers (*boru*), who are both distinguished from one's line (*dongan sabutuha*). The Toba Batak describe their tripartite system as *Dalihan na Tolu*, literally "a three-cornered stand on which cooking pots were placed in olden days" (Cunningham 1958:25). *Hulahula* are characterized by spiritual power and ceremonial superiority, whereas *boru* respect and worship their *hulahula* and expect to receive blessing from them. I could find no meaning for the term *hulahula* apart from that of wife-givers. *Boru* means "female" or "daughter", and *dongan sabutuha* are "those who originate from one womb" (Vergouwen 1964:16; Tobing 1956:84). There is no general word for affines, rather they are always distinguished as wife-givers or wife-takers.

TABLE 1: RELATIONSHIP TERMINOLOGY (MALE EGO)

Term of Reference	Genealogical Level Relative to Ego's	Term of Address	Genealogical Specifications
1. <i>iboto</i>	+0	<i>ito</i>	Z, FBD, FZD, FZSW, MZD, ZHZ, FMBDD
<i>iboto na mulak</i>	+2	<i>ito</i>	FFZ
2. <i>lae</i>	+0	<i>lae</i>	ZH, FBDH, FZS, FZDH, MZDH, ZHZH, FMBDDH, WFZDH
<i>lae na mulak</i>	+2	<i>lae</i>	FFZH
3. <i>tunggane</i>	+0	<i>lae</i>	MBS, WB, WFBS, WMZS, WMBS, WMBDH, BWB
<i>tunggane na mulak</i>	-2	<i>lae</i>	MBSSS, WBSS, WMBSSS, WMBDSS, WMBSSDH
4. <i>anggang</i>	+0	<i>anggang</i>	oB, FoBS, MoZS, MBDH, FMBDS, MFZSS
<i>anggang boru</i>	+0	<i>anggang boru</i>	oBW, FoBSW, MoZSW, MFZSSW, FMBDSW
<i>anggang pariban</i>	+0	<i>anggang</i>	WoZ, WFoBD, WFZS, WMoZD, WFFZSS, WFMBDD, WMFZDS, WMFZDS, WMFZSD (and spouses)
<i>anggang pariban na mulak</i>	+2	<i>anggang</i>	WFZZ, WFFZH
5. <i>anggi</i>	+0	<i>anggi</i> , "ama ni _"	yB, FyBS, MyZS, MBDH, FMBDS
<i>anggi boru</i>	+0	<i>inang</i>	yBW, FyBSW, MyZSW, FMBDSW
<i>anggi pariban</i>	+0	<i>anggi</i>	WyZ, WFyBD, WFZS, WMyZD, WFFZSS, WFMBDD, WMFZDS, WMFZSD (and spouses)
<i>anggi pariban na mulak</i>	-2	<i>anggi</i>	MBSSD, WBSD, WMBDSD, (and spouses)
6. <i>ampara</i>	+0	<i>ampara</i>	MyZS, WFyBDH, WMyZDH
7. <i>pariban (boru ni tulang)</i>	+0	<i>pariban</i> , name	MBD, MMZSD, MFBSD, MMBDD, FMBSD

Term of Reference	Genealogical Level Relative to Ego's	Term of Address	Genealogical Specifications
8. boru ni tulang so siolion	+0	bao, inang bao	MMBSD, WMBD, WFMBSD, WMFBSD, WMMZSD, WMMBSD, WMMBDD
9. inang bao (bao)	+0	bao, inang bao	WBW, WMBSW, MBSW
inang bao na mulak	-2	bao, inang bao	WBSSW, WMBSSW, WMBDSSW, WMBSSD, MBSSSW
10. tunggane boru, inanta jabunami	+0	"ompu ni __", inang	W
11. amang	+1	amang	F, MFZS, FMBDH, WFZH
amanguda	+1	amanguda	FyB, MyZH
amangtua	+1	amangtua	FoB, MoZH
amang na matua	+3	amangtua	FFF, FFFB
12. inang	+1	inang	M, MFZSW, FMBD, WFZ
inang baju	+1	inang baju	unmarried: MyZ
inanguda	+1	inanguda	married: MyZ; FyBW
inangtua	+1	inangtua	MoZ, FoBW
inang na matua	+3	inangtua	FFM, FFFBW
13. namboru	+1	namboru	FZ, ZHM, FZHZ, FFZSW, FFZD, MFZD
14. amangboru	+1	amangboru	FZH, ZHF, FZHZH, FFZS, FFZDH, MFZDH
15. tulang	+1	tulang	MB, BWF, MBWB, FMBS, MMBS, MMBDH, WFMB, WMMBS, WMMBDH, WFMBDH
tulang rorobot	+1	tulang	WMB
tulang simatua	+1	tulang	WFFBS
tulang na poso	-1	tulang	MBSS, WBS; WMBSS, WMBDS
16. nantulang	+1	nantulang	MBW, BWB, MBWBW, FMBSW, MMBSW, MMBD, WFMBSW, WMMBSW, WMMBD, WFMBD
nantulang rorobot	+1	nantulang	WMBW
nantulang simatua	+1	nantulang	WFFBSW
nantulang naposo	-1	nantulang	MBSSW, WBSW, WMBSSW, WMBDSW
17. simatua	+1	amang	WF, WFB, WMZH, WMFZS
		inang	WM, WFBW, WMZ, WMFZSW
18. anak	-1	*anak, anaha, amang, name, "ama ni __"	S, BS, MBDS, MBSDH, WBDH, WZS, WFZSS
19. boru	-1	boru, ito, inang, name, "nai __"	D, BD, FZSSW, FZDSW, MBDD, ZSW, WZD, WFZSD
20. parumaen	-1	inang, inang parumaen	SW, BSW, MBDSW, WZSW, WFZSSW
maen	-1	maen, name, "nai __"	WBD, WMBSD, WMBDD, MBSD
21. hela	-1	amanghela, amang + marga	DH, BDH, MBDDH, WZDH, WFZSDH

Term of Reference	Genealogical Level Relative to Ego's	Term of Address	Genealogical Specifications
22. bere	-1	bere, name marga	ZC, FZDC, FZSC, WFZDC ZDH, FZDDH, FZSDH, WFZDDH
bere na mulak	+1	bere	FFZD, FFZDH
23. ompung	+2	ompung, ompung doli	FF, MF, FMB, FMZH, MFZH, MMB, WFF, WMF, WFFZH, WFMB, WMFZH, WMMB
		ompung, ompung boru	FM, MM, FMBW, FMZ, MFZ, MMBW, WMM, WFFZ, WFM, WFMBW, WMFZ, WMMBW
24. pahompu	-2	pahompu, anggi, name (except for ... DH for whom marga must be used)	SC, DC, BDC, BSC, ZSC, ZDC, FZSSC, FZSDC, FZDSC, FZDDC, MBSDC, MBDDC, WBDC, WZSC, WZDC, WFZSSC, WFZSDC, WFZDSC, WFZDDC, WMBSDC, WMBDDC (and spouses)
pahompu na mulak	+0	pahompu, name	FFZDS, FFZDSW, FFZDD, FFZDDH
25. nini	-3	anak, boru, name	SCC
26. nono	-3	bere, name	DCC

TABLE II: RELATIONSHIP TERMINOLOGY (FEMALE EGO)

Term of Reference	Genealogical Level Relative to Ego's	Term of Address	Genealogical Specifications
1. iboto	+0	ito	B, FBS, MBS, MZS, MBDH, MFZSS, BWB
iboto na mulak	+2	ito	HFMB
	-2	ito	BSS, MBSSS, MBDSS, MBSSDH, HMBSSS
2. eda	+0	eda, marga	BW, FBSW, MZSW, MBD, MBSW, MFZSSW, BWBW, HMBSW
		eda, name "nai ____"	FZD, HZ, HFBD, HFZSW, HFZD, HMZD, ZHZ
eda na mulak	+2	eda	HFFZ, HFMBW
	-2	eda	BSSW, MBSSSW, MBDSSW, MBSSD, HMBSSSW
3. angkang	+0	angkang	oZ, FoBD, FZSW, MoZD, FFZSSW, MFZSD, FMBDD
angkang boru	+0	angkang boru	HMBD, HMoZSW, HFMBSD, HMMBSD, HMMBDD, HoBW, HFoBSW
angkang doli	+0	angkang doli	oZH, FoBDH, MoZDH, HMoZS, HMBDH, HFMBSDH, HMMBSDH, HMMBDDH, HoB

Term of Reference	Genealogical Level Relative to Ego's	Term of Address	Genealogical Specifications
angkang na mulak	+2	angkang	FFZ, FFZH
4. haha	+0	haha doli haha boru	HoB, HFoBS HoBW, HFoBSW
5. anggi	+0	anggi, "nai ____"	yZ, FyBD, FZSW, MyZD, FMBDD, MFZSD, FFZSSW
anggi boru	+0	anggi boru, "nai ____"	HyBW, HFyBSW, HMyZSW, HMBD, HFMBDSW
anggi doli	+0	anggi doli, "ama ni ____"	yZH, FyBDH, MyZDH, FMBDDH, MFZSDH, HyB, HFyBS, HMyZS, HMBDDH, HFMBDS
anggi na mulak	-2	anggi	BSD, MBDS (and spouses)
6. pariban (anak ni namboru)	+0	pariban, name	FZS, FMZDS, FFBDS, FFZSS, MFZDS
pariban	+0	angkang, anggi	Z, FBD, MZD
7. amang bao (bao)	+0	bao, amang bao	HZH, HFZS, HFZDH, FZDH, FFZDS
amang bao na mulak	+2	bao, amang bao	HFFZH
8. tunggane doli, amanta jabunami	+0	"ompu ni ____"	H
9. amang	+1	amang	F, MFZS, FMBDH, HMB
amanguda	+1	amanguda	FyB, MyZH
amangtua	+1	amangtua	FoB, MoZH
amang na matua	+3	amangtua	FFF, FFFB
amang na poso (paraman)	-1	amang	BS, MBDS, HMBSS
10. inang	+1	inang	M, MFZSW, FMBD, HMBW
inang baju	+1	inang baju	unmarried: MyZ
inanguda	+1	inanguda	married: MyZ; FyBW
inangtua	+1	inangtua	MoZ, FoBW
inang na matua	+3	inangtua	FM, FFFBW
inang na poso	-1	inang	BSW, MBDSW, HMBSSW
11. namboru	+1	namboru	FZ, ZHM, FZHZ, FFZSW, FFZD, MFZD, HFZ, HFFZD, HMFZD
12. amangboru	+1	amangboru	FZH, ZHF, FZHZH, FFZS, FFZDH, MFZDH, HFZH, HFFZDH, HMFZDH
13. tulang	+1	tulang	MB, BWF, MBWB, FMBS, MMBS, FMBDDH, MMBDDH
tulang na poso	-1	tulang	MBSS
14. nantulang	+1	nantulang	MBW, BW, MBWB, FMBSW, MMBSW, FMBD, MMBD
nantulang na poso	-1	nantulang	MBSSW
15. simatua	+1	amang inang	HF, HFB, HMZH, HMFZS HM, HMZ, HFBW, HMFZSW
16. anak	-1	anak, anaha, amang, name, "ama ni ____"	S, ZS, BDH, FZSS, MZSDH, MBDDH, MBSDDH, HBS, HMBSDH, HMBDS

Term of Reference	Genealogical Level Relative to Ego's	Term of Address	Genealogical Specifications
17. boru	-1	boru, inang, name, "nai _"	D, ZD, FZSD, FZDSW, HBD, HFZSSW, HFZDSW, HMBDD
18. parumaen	-1	parumaen, name, "nai _"	SW, ZSW, FZSSW, HBSW, HMBDSW
maen	-1	maen, name, anggi, "nai _"	BD, MBSD, MBDD, HMBSD
19. hela	-1	amanghela, amang + marga	DH, ZDH, FZSDH, HBDH, HMBDDH
20. bere	-1	bere, name marga	FZDC, HZC, HFZDC, HFZSC, FZDDH, HZDH, HFZDDH, HFZSDH
21. ompung	+2	ompung, ompung doli	FF, MF, FMB, MFZH, MMB, HFF, HMF, HMFb, HMFZH, HMMb, HFMZH
		ompung, ompung boru	FM, MM, FMBW, MFZ, MMBW, HFM, HFMZ, HMFbW, HMFZ, HMM, HMMbW
ompung na poso	+0	ompung	MBS, FMBSS, MMBSS (and spouses)
22. pahompu	-2	pahompu, anggi, name (except for ... DH for whom marga must be used)	SC, DC, BDC, ZSC, ZDC, FZSSC, FZDSC, FZSDC, FZDDC, MBSDC, MBDDC, HBDC, HBSC, HZSC, HZDC, HFZSSC, HFZDSC, HFZSDC, HFZDDC, HMBSDC, HMBDDC (and spouses)
23. nini	-3	anak, boru, name	SCC
24. nono	+3	bere, name	DCC

General Observations

Tables I and II record terms of reference and address for male and female egos. Genealogically redundant specifications are omitted.³

The application of the terms for ego's same-sex siblings, *anggang* and *anggi*, varies depending on the speaker's place of origin in the Toba Batak homeland. In the Toba area,⁴ the age distinction is made with reference to the linking relative, whereas in Silindung, it is made in ego's level. A man from Toba would call his FoBS *anggang*, regardless of their relative ages, while a man from Silindung may use *anggi* if his FoBS is younger. The application of *anggang* and *anggi* to ego's *pariban* spouse and to the children of ego's parents' *pariban* is determined by the order of marriage.

Lae and *tunggane* are used only by a male speaker. *Lae* refers to the *boru* component of the brother-in-law category. *Tunggane* is used as a term of reference for male wife-givers in ego's generation and is the reciprocal of *lae*. It implies respect (Fischer 1966:253), and means

"elder" (Tambunan 1977; Vergouwen 1964:47). An informant stated that it was derived from *na tumungane*, "revered".

Ampara, an alternative term used between men whose mothers or wives are actual or classificatory sisters, is usually applied toward a man who is chronically older than ego but genealogically younger and who should actually be classified as *anggi*. Because this is an uncomfortable situation, *ampara* tends to be used to avoid emphasizing age differences. Vergouwen (1964:24) and Cunningham (1958:24) note the use of *ampara* between full brothers. Most of my informants stated that this would be inappropriate because it is in precisely these contexts that age differences must be maintained.

The reciprocal term *pariban* indicates the prescribed category for marriage, and a woman's sisters. According to Fischer (1966:256), *pariban* means "to belong to myself" or "the owner of the same *hulahula*". A man and his *pariban* (or his wife) both refer to her father and brothers as their *hulahula*⁵ and a woman and her sisters share the same *hulahula*. Informants stated that, although this is true, the origin of the term is from the expression *na pinariba*, "that which we consider to be identical to ourselves". This agrees with Tambunan's gloss of the root *iba* as "me" or "myself" (Tambunan 1977). Although Fischer (1966:255) states that *pariban* is also used between the husbands of sisters, this is not in accord with my data.

Boru ni tulang so siolion, "the MBD who must not be married", refers to the category containing the MBD of a man's MBS, and differentiates wife-givers of wife-givers from wife-givers in ego's own generation.

The use of *tungane* in the terms of reference for spouses, *tungane doli* and *tungane boru*, connotes respect (Ihromi 1963:35). The terms for spouses, including *amanta jabunami*, "the father in our house", and *inanta jabunami*, "the mother in our house", are used only by third persons. Informants stated that direct references to or address of the husband or wife was avoided if at all possible, but in unavoidable circumstances the Indonesian teknonym *Bapak si/Mamak si* [name of eldest child], "father/mother of __", is often used.

According to informants, *amangboru* is derived from *amang* + *boru*, "father of the *boru*", and *namboru* from *inang* + *boru*, "mother of the *boru*".

Parents-in-law are referred to as *simatua*, "the elder", a term of respect. The term is anomalous because it labels a purely affinal category rather than one defined by both affinal and consanguineal specifications as is usual for asymmetric prescriptive terminologies.

Parumaen is derived from *maen*, "daughter-in-law" (Tambunan 1977). Vergouwen considers *maen* a shortened form of *parumaen* (Vergouwen 1964:225), and Ihromi (1963) does not distinguish between the two. I find that they are not interchangeable, but that *parumaen* is more narrowly defined, limited to the wives of those classified as *anak* in a

man's line of reference or a woman's husband's line. *Maen* and *parumaen* should nevertheless be classed together because the husbands of both are *anak* (*parumaen*'s husband by virtue of his position in the line of reference, and *maen*'s husband only after marriage). Informants stated that *maen* of the wife-giving line are "potential daughters-in-law", in that if they married *anak* they would become *parumaen*.

Hela refers to sons-in-law. Potential sons-in-law (a man's ZS, etc., according to prescription) are *bere*. *Bere na mulak* is an alternative term for a man's FFZD and FFZDH, otherwise called *namboru* and *amangboru*.

The term *ompung* is derived from the root *ompu*, which means "ancestor or grandparent" (Tambunan 1977) and "all that people wish to worship" (Tobing 1956:42). *Ompu* is derived from the proto-Austro-nesian **e(m)pu* and is related to similar words associated with social distance and an attitude of respect in several modern Indonesian languages (Barnes 1979:19). The term for grandparent is also related to a general Indonesian honorific. In Karo Batak, *ẽmpu* is the master or owner of something (Barnes 1979:24). The Toba Batak *ompu i* is an honorific and *ompu* is a title of respect.

Ompu also forms the root of the term *pahompu*, grandchild. Fischer (1966:258) notes that the reciprocal address for grandparent and grandchild is *ompung*, but usage among my informants does not confirm this.

Four terms are used only by women. *Eda* refers to both wife-givers and wife-takers, who are distinguished by the term of address. *Haha* is often merged with *anggang*. Vergouwen (1964:66) states that *haha* may also be applied to a woman's sister, but I did not find this to be true. *Amang na poso*, "young father", is an alternative term of reference for *paraman* (*par-ama-an*), "the one who is like a father". Both are used for BS. *Ompung na poso* is an alternative term for a woman's MBS, MBSW, etc., otherwise called *iboto* or *eda*.

There are several auxiliary terms which clarify sex, alliance status, relative age, and generation. *Boru*, "female", and *doli* (*baoa* in the Toba region), "male", are optionally added to *ompung* and *simatua*, but are obligatory for *haha* and certain specifications of *anggang* and *anggi*. Affinal status is specified by the addition of *boru*, *doli*, or the auxiliary *pariban* to *anggang* or *anggi*. In the case of *simatua*, *amang* and *inang* may also indicate sex.

The suffixes *-tua*, "older", and *-uda*, "younger", are added to *amang* and *inang* to distinguish by relative age within these categories. The addition of *baju* to *inang* signifies that she is *na marbaju*, "not yet married".

By the addition of the auxiliaries *bao* and *suhut*, *ompung* can be differentiated according to alliance status. *Bao* indicates mother's parent, whereas *suhut* indicates father's parent.

The auxiliary terms *mangulahi*, *na mulak*, *na matua*, and *na poso*

signify the application of a term to a generation other than its focus. *Mangulahi* and *na mulak* are used interchangeably, and mean "to repeat", from the root *ulak*, "to repeat, return, or come home" (Tambunan 1977; Fischer 1966:260). *Na matua*, "the elder", is used above the second ascending generation, and *na poso*, "young in years" (Fischer 1966:259)⁶, indicates the application of a term to a generation below its focus.

The addition of *rorobot* to the term *tulang* indicates the wife's MB. *Ro* literally means "to come"; *robot* means "late at night". *Tulang rorobot* traditionally was one of the last to arrive at a ceremony because he came from the farthest village.

Tulang simatua signifies a *tulang* who is also parent-in-law. In a prescribed marriage, although ego's WFFBS would be his *tulang*, ego also considers him a parent-in-law because his wife calls him *amangtua* or *amanguda*.

The Toba Batak do not usually distinguish between real and classificatory relatives. If necessary, the Indonesian term *kandung*, "from one womb", can be appended.

My informants in Medan avoided the use of certain Toba Batak terms because they felt them to be constraining. The substitution of Indonesian teknonyms for husband and wife has already been mentioned. In addition, the Indonesian *ibu* (M), *mamak* (M), or *bapak* (F), or Dutch *mami* (M) or *papi* (F) were often used for parents. Siblings were often referred to by the Indonesian *abang* (oB), *kakak* (oB or oZ), or *adik* (yB or yZ) and addressed by *bang* or *kak* followed by their name for older siblings, or by *dik* or simply their name for younger siblings. The only substitution outside the nuclear family was the Dutch *tante* (MyZ) for *inang baju*.

Reference Terms (Male Ego)

The relationship terminology is ordered according to patrilineal descent and asymmetric prescription. Prescription is used, in Needham's sense, to indicate a formal feature of a terminology, "a constant relation that articulates lines and categories" (Needham 1973:174).

Table III portrays categories of descent and alliance for male ego's terms of reference.

The lineal character of the terminology is confirmed by the following equations and distinctions:

F = FB	D = BD	FZ ≠ MZ	FBS ≠ MBS	BS ≠ ZS	BD ≠ WBD
M = MZ	S = BS	B ≠ FZS	FBS ≠ FZS	S ≠ WBS	BD ≠ ZD
B = FBS	FB ≠ MB	B ≠ MBS	MBS ≠ FZS	D ≠ ZD	S ≠ ZS
Z = FBD	FB ≠ FZH	Z ≠ MBD	BS ≠ WBS	FBD ≠ MBD	

In contrast to other terminologies of this type, lineality is expressed in the second ascending and descending generations by $FFB \neq FFZH$, $FMZ \neq FFZ$, $SS \neq WBSS$, and $SS \neq MBSS$. However, these distinctions are not complete since $FFB \neq FMB$ and $SS \neq ZSS$ do not appear.

TABLE III: TOBA BATAK CATEGORIES OF DESCENT AND ALLIANCE
(REFERENCE; MALE EGO)*

f	m	←	f	m	←	f	m	←	f	m
iboto na mulak	lae na mulak		iboto na mulak	ompung angkang pariban na mulak		ompung angkang pariban na mulak	ompung		ompung	ompung
namboru (bere na mulak)	amangboru		namboru	amangtua amang amanguda		inangtua inang inanguda inang baju	simatua tulang tulang simatua		simatua nantulang nantulang simatua	tulang rorobot tulang
boto (pahompu na mulak)	lae		iboto	angkang pariban angkang EGO anggi anggi pariban		angkang pariban angkang boru inanta jabunami pariban anggi pariban anggi boru	tunggane		inang bao boru ni tulang so siolion	tunggane
bere	hela bere		boru	anak		parumaen maen	tulang na poso anak		nantulang na poso maen	tulang na poso
pahompu	pahompu		pahompu	pahompu anggi pariban na mulak		pahompu anggi pariban	pahompu tunggane na mulak		pahompu inang bao na mulak	tunggane na mulak

* Alternative terms in parentheses.

Patrilineal descent produces the following equations:

$$\begin{array}{lll} F = FFF & FFZH = FZS = ZH & MB = MBSS \\ Z = FFZ & FFZD = FZSD & MBS = MBSS \end{array}$$

The principle of the equivalence of alternate generations precludes certain equations which are consistent with patrilineal descent:

$$FZH = FZS \quad FZD = FZSD \quad F = FF \quad MB = MBS$$

The following verify an asymmetric (matrilineal) prescription:

$$\begin{array}{llll} MBD = BW^7 & FZH = ZHF & MBS = WB & FZH \neq MB \quad MBS \neq ZH \\ MBDH = oB^8 & FBD = Z & FZS = ZH & FZ \neq WM \quad MBD \neq FZD \\ ZS = DH^9 & BD = MBDD = ZSW & ZD = FZSD & FZH \neq WF \quad WB \neq ZH \\ MB = BWF & MZS = WZH = B & WZS = S & MB \neq ZHF \quad DH \neq WBS \\ MBW = BWM & MBSD = WBD = SW^{10} & WFZ = M & MBW \neq ZHM \quad SW \neq ZD \\ FZ = ZHM & FZD = Z = ZHZ & WFZH = F & ZHZ \neq BW \quad WBW \neq Z \\ FB = MZH = MFZS = WFZH & & WFZS = B & ZDH \neq S \quad WBS \neq ZS \\ MZ = FBW = FMBD = WFZ & & FZ \neq MBW & MBS \neq FZS \end{array}$$

As is true for Rindi (Forth 1981:312), Endeh (Needham 1968:173), and Tanebar-Evav (Barraud 1979:129), the equation $FZD = Z$ is in accord with the prohibition of marriage with the FZD.

Whereas the Toba Batak terminology distinguishes MBD from FZD, in contrast to the Karo Batak *impal* (MBC and FZC) (Singarimbun 1975; Needham 1978), it does contain certain symmetric features such as an equivalence of WB and ZH in the address terminology and a symmetric term for parent-in-law, *simatua*.

Although other asymmetric prescriptive terminologies such as Karo Batak (Needham 1978), Rindi (Forth 1981), and Kédang (Barnes 1974) do not mark asymmetry in the second ascending and descending levels, the Toba Batak terminology does. Second descending generation wife-givers are distinguished by own-generation terms (*tunggane*, *inang bao*, and *anggi pariban*). In the second ascending generation, wife-takers and ego's own line are marked by the own-generation terms *lae*, *iboto*, and *angkang pariban*. *Ompung* is used for wife-givers and ego's own line.

The following equations and distinctions show that the terminology does not define a closed cycle of three lines, that is, wife-givers of wife-givers are not equated with wife-takers and wife-takers of wife-takers are not equated with wife-givers.

$$\begin{array}{lll} MB = MBWB & FZ = FZHZ & MBW \neq FZHZ \quad MBSW \neq FZD \\ MBW = MBWBW & FZH = FZHZH & FZ \neq MBWBW \end{array}$$

These equations class wife-givers of wife-givers with wife-givers and wife-takers of wife-takers with wife-takers in the first ascending generation, but five lines are actually necessary to adequately represent the terminology. This requirement is also true of the Pak-pak Batak terminology (Viner 1981:161) and that of the Kachin (Leach 1965:305; 1961:41). Needham remarks that the equivalence of wife-givers of wife-givers with wife-givers and wife-takers of wife-takers with wife-

takers among the Karo Batak is comparatively unusual. In the Toba Batak terminology in ego's own generation wife-givers of wife-givers are distinguished by *inang bao* and *boru ni tulang so siolion*, whereas *pariban* is used for wife-givers, and wife-takers may be distinguished by *pa-hompup na mulak* instead of *lae* or *iboto*, which are terms for wife-takers. Taking into account the alternative usage of *bere na mulak* for FFZD and FFZDH, the wife-takers of ego's wife-takers may also be distinguished in the first ascending generation. In the first descending generation, SW (*parumaen*) is distinguished from WBSW (*nantulang na poso*).

The division in ego's own generation of female wife-givers of wife-givers into two categories seems to be peculiar to the Toba Batak. *Boru ni tulang so siolion* is distinguished from *inang bao* in order to differentiate actual and potential wives of wife-givers. A man's *inang bao* are the wives of his *tunggane* and clearly not available for marriage. His *boru ni tulang so siolion* appears to be marriageable since she is a MBD, but she is actually considered a type of *inang bao*. This is confirmed by the use of *bao* for address and by an examination of the women's terminology which reveals that ego's *boru ni tulang so siolion* refers to him as *bao*, which is a reciprocal term.

Boru ni tulang so siolion is the only term about which there was substantial disagreement among my informants. Whereas MBD, MMZSD, and MFBSD are unanimously classified as *pariban*, and MMBSD, WMBD, WFMBSD, WMFBSD, WMMZSD, WMMBSD, and WMMBDD as *boru ni tulang so siolion*, informants disagreed on the classification of MMBDD, FMBSD, and FMBDD.¹¹ Other studies of the terminology do not resolve this confusion since they do not refer to *boru ni tulang so siolion* nor, except for Ihromi (1963), do they describe relationship terminology beyond three lines.

Reference Terms (Female Ego)

A woman's position in an asymmetric system is sometimes ambiguous because she changes clan membership upon marriage (Barnes 1974; Forth 1981), resulting in a muddling of the wife-giver/wife-taker distinction of her natal line and her husband's line. Her husband's line becomes her frame of reference. Her father and her brothers (her line of origin) become her wife-givers, and her mother's line becomes the wife-giver of her wife-givers. In accordance with patrilineal descent, a woman's children belong to her husband's line, thus her wife-takers in descending generations are her husband's wife-taking line. Even though this may seem confusing, the changes are predictable and underline Barnes' statement that "the [Kédang] women's terminology becomes somewhat less systematically ordered but in a measured way resulting from a necessary feature of this system in operation" (Barnes 1974: 279).

TABLE IV: TOBA BATAK CATEGORIES OF DESCENT AND ALLIANCE
(REFERENCE; FEMALE EGO)*

f	m	←	f	m	←	f	m	←	f	m
eda na mulak	amang bao na mulak		eda na mulak	ompung anggang na mulak		ompung anggang na mulak	ompung iboto na mulak		ompung eda na mulak	ompung
namboru	amangboru		namboru	simantua amangboru		simantua namboru	amangtua amang amanguda		inangtua inang inanguda inang baju	tulang
eda	amang bao		eda	(haha doli) anggang doli amanta jabunami pariban anggi doli		(haha boru) anggang (pariban) anggang boru EGO anggi boru anggi (pariban)	iboto		eda	iboto (ompung na poso)
bere	hela bere		boru	anak		parumaen maen	amang na poso (paraman) anak		inang na poso maen	tulang na poso
pahompu	pahompu		pahompu	pahompu anggi na mulak		pahompu anggi na mulak	pahompu iboto na mulak		pahompu eda na mulak	iboto na mulak

* Alternative terms in parentheses.

Table IV contains women's categories of descent and alliance. The women's terms also conform to patrilineal descent and asymmetric alliance.

The men's equations and distinctions confirming lineal descent hold for the women's terminology with the following exceptions:

S = ZS D = ZD D ≠ BD S ≠ BS B ≠ FZS MZS ≠ FZS

The first four are a logical consequence of seeing the rule of patrilineal descent from a woman's point of view, and the last two result from a woman's perspective on the asymmetric prescription.

Lineality is expressed in the second ascending generation by FFB = FFZH and FMZ ≠ FFZ, but FFB ≠ FMB and FMZ ≠ FMBW do not occur. The second descending generation, although characterized by the application of *pahomp* to some specifications in each line, also contains terms which distinguish alliance status. Ego's husband's line is characterized by the application of *anggi na mulak*, and her wife-givers are distinguished by *iboto na mulak* and *eda na mulak*.

Patrilineal descent is demonstrated by the same equations which apply to the men's terminology, with two qualifications: FFZD = FZSD and FFZH = FZS do not apply to the women's terminology because FZS is in the prescribed category for marriage, and only in the women's terminology do MBS = MF (in the case of the alternative term *ompung na poso*) and F = BS appear.

The principle of the equivalence of alternate generations precludes FF = F, MB = MBS, FZS = FZH and FZD = FZSD, which we would expect to find in a patrilineal system.

The equations and distinctions particular to the women's terminology which verify an asymmetric prescription are as follows:

FB = MZH = MFZS = HMB	ZS = BDH = FZSS	HMB = F	FZ ≠ BWM
MZ = FBW = FMBD = HMBW	MBS = B = BWB	HMBD = Z	BWB ≠ ZH
FZS = ZH ¹²	FZD = HZ	FBD = HBW = Z	BSW ≠ D
FZSW = oZ ¹³	MZS = B	MBD = BW	MBW ≠ HM
BD = SW ¹⁴	BS = MBDS	HBD = D	HZD ≠ BD
FZDS = HZS = DH ¹⁵	HMBW = M	MB ≠ HF	DH ≠ BS
		FZH ≠ BWF	SW ≠ HZD

MBS = B accords with the prohibition of marriage with the MBS dictated by the asymmetric prescription. Other than adjustments made to see the prescription from a female speaker's point of view, the only difference with the men's terminology is the absence in the women's terminology of HZ ≠ BW and MBD ≠ FZD. Instead of distinguishing wife-givers (BW and MBD) and wife-takers (HZ and FZD), both are *eda*.

In the second descending generation ego's own line and her wife-givers may be distinguished by terms from other generations. In the second ascending generation each line may be differentiated in this way.

The women's terminology also does not define a three-line closed cycle of relations, rather five lines are required for a complete represen-

TABLE V: TOBA BATAK CATEGORIES OF DESCENT AND ALLIANCE
(ADDRESS; MALE EGO)*

f	m	←	f	m	←	f	m	←	f	m
ito	lae		ito	ompung angkang		ompung angkang	ompung		ompung	ompung
namboru (bere)	amangboru		namboru	amangtua amang amanguda		inangtua inang inanguda inang baju	amang tulang		inang nantulang	tulang
ito (pahompu; name)	lae		ito	angkang EGO anggi; teknonymy		angkang angkang boru teknonymy; inang pariban; name anggi inang	lae		bao	lae
bere; name	amanghela; amang ≠ marga teknonymy		boru; ito; inang; name;	anak; name; amang; teknonymy teknonymy		inang parumaen maen; name;	tulang anak; name; amang; teknonymy		nantulang maen; name; teknonymy	tulang
pahompu; anggi; name	pahompu; marga; [... DH]; anggi; name		pahompu; anggi; name	pahompu; marga; [... DH]; anggi; name anggi		pahompu; anggi; name anggi	pahompu; marga; [... DH]; anggi; name lae		pahompu; anggi; name bao	lae

* Alternative terms in parentheses.

TABLE VI: TOBA BATAK CATEGORIES OF DESCENT AND ALLIANCE
(ADDRESS; FEMALE EGO)*

f	m	←	f	m	←	f	m	←	f	m
eda	bao		eda	ompung angkang		ompung angkang	ompung ito		ompung eda	ompung
namboru	amangboru		namboru	amang amangboru		inang namboru	amangtua amang amanguda		inangtua inang inanguda inang baju	tulang
eda; name; teknonymy	bao		eda; name; teknonymy	(haha doli) angkang doli teknonymy pariban; name anggi doli; teknonymy		(haha boru) angkang angkang boru EGO anggi; boru; teknonymy anggi; teknonymy	ito		eda; marga	ito (ompung)
bere; name; anggi; name	amanghela; amang + marga bere; name		boru; inang; teknonymy; name	anak; amang; teknonymy; name		parumaen; name; teknonymy maen; name; anggi; teknonymy	amang anak; amang; teknonymy; name		inang maen; name; anggi; teknonymy	tulang
pahompu; anggi; name	pahompu; marga [... DH]; anggi; name		pahompu; anggi; name	pahompu; marga [... DH]; anggi; name anggi		pahompu; anggi; name anggi	pahompu; marga [... DH]; anggi; name ito		pahompu; anggi; name eda	ito

* Alternative terms in parentheses.

tation. Whereas wife-givers of wife-givers appear to be classed with wife-givers and wife-takers of wife-takers in the first ascending generation, in ego's own generation male wife-takers (*pariban*) are distinguished from male wife-takers of wife-takers (*amang bao*) and wife-givers of wife-givers (from her vantage point in her husband's line) may be distinguished by *ompung na poso*. In the first ascending generation, the terminology distinguishes DH from HZDH. This distinction is not true of the Karo Batak terminology in which both are *kela* (Singarimbun 1975; Needham 1978).

Terms of Address

Terms of address are shown in Tables V and VI. Some terms of reference are not used for address: *angkang pariban*, *anggi pariban*, *iboto*, *anggi boru* (by a man), *tunggane doli*, *amanta jabunami*, *tunggane boru*, *inanta jabunami*, *simatua*, and *tunggane*. The correct term of address for *iboto* is *ito*, derived from the same root. I do not know, nor did my informants, why they are distinguished. We might expect that alliance status would be clarified in the address for parent-in-law, since the term of reference is symmetrical, but this is not the case. *Ito* and *amanghela* are the only terms used solely for address. The address terminology for *eda* expresses an alliance status distinction masked by reference terminology, and the asymmetry of *lae* is problematical since WB and ZH are distinguished by the term of reference.

The terms of address which are applied to the greatest number of reference categories are *inang* and *amang*. *Inang* connotes relationships ranging from familiarity (D) and intimacy tempered by respect (W) to distance and respect (WM and HM) and distance (BW, a man's SW, or a woman's BSW). All those addressed as *inang* are affines, except for M and D, and in a generation adjacent to ego's own, except for a man's wife and yBW. *Amang* is used in a similar fashion to address F, HF, WF, S, DH, and a woman's BS, but it is not applied to a woman's H or a man's yB as might be expected by comparison with the use of *inang*.

In addition to relationship terms, name, teknonymy, and *marga* are also used for persons addressed in ego's own generation or below. Name and parental teknonymy are more familiar and *marga* and grandparental teknonymy are more formal. Address by name is never used toward those of greater age or wife-giver status (except for a man's *pariban* and his wife's BD and BDH whose higher alliance status may be negated by their genealogical level). Address by *marga* is not most respectful. It is used only for affines and, with the exception of wife-giver *eda*, is applied only to wife-takers. Teknonymy emphasizes the continuity, renewal, and cyclical nature of the relationship terminology. Two forms are used: *nai/ama ni* __, "mother/father of __", with reference to the eldest child, or *ompu ni* __, "grandparent of __", with reference to the eldest child of the eldest son. If grandchildren have only been provided by daughters,

the proper form of address is *ompu ni si* __, "grandparent of __". In the first descending generation, name is also appropriate wherever teknonymy is allowed. The use of name is forbidden for spouses, and teknonymy is limited to the more respectful form.

Principles of Classification

Five principles of classification are derived from the terms of reference: genealogical level, alliance status (the distinction of wife-givers from wife-takers), sex, relative age, and order of marriage. They are characterized by inequality such that ascending generations are superior to descending generations, wife-givers are superior to wife-takers, male is superior to female, older is superior to younger, and earlier marriage is superior to later marriage.

Genealogical level is, for other asymmetric terminologies, the most distinctive criterion of classification, at least within the line of reference. This is not true of the Toba Batak terminology, in which ten of twenty-six terms used by a male speaker and twelve of twenty-five women's terms are applied in more than one genealogical level. In itself this is not unusual since other asymmetric terminologies make lineal equivalences. What is unusual about the Toba Batak terminology is the extent to which it disregards genealogical level, the form the equivalences take, and the purpose to which they are put. The lineal equivalences combine alternate rather than adjacent generations and work to reinforce alliance status. In general, wife-giver positions are elevated, whereas those of wife-takers and ego's own line are lowered.

The principle of the combination of alternate generations operates to equate patrilineally related males (who call each other *ompung* and *pahompu*) or patrilineally related females (who use *angkang* and *anggi*). For example, a man's *angkang pariban na mulak* is FFZ to his *anggi pariban na mulak*, so they call each other *angkang* and *anggi*. A woman's *amang* is FF to her *amang na poso* so they use *ompung* and *pahompu*, underlining the fact that SS is seen as the structural replacement for FF.

Although Ihromi notes a tendency to combine alternate generations in the Toba Batak terminology, she underemphasizes its pervasiveness and ramifications for alliance status. She is correct that a woman's MBS = FF¹⁶, a man's WBS = MB and a woman's BS = F, but her treatment is incomplete because she does not observe that a man's FFZ = Z, his FFZH = ZH, and his FFZD = ZD. Her conclusion that this principle is "especially significant in the terminology of ego towards his mother's lineage, male ego's wife's lineage of origin, and female ego's father's lineage, that is . . . towards one's *hulahula*" (Ihromi 1963:44) is inadequate because it does not consider equivalences in ego's own line or that of his wife-takers.

The combination of alternate generations in the wife-givers or wife-givers of wife-givers line common to the men's and women's termino-

logy is demonstrated by the following equations:

$$MB = MBSS \quad MBW = MBSSW \quad MBS = MBSSS \quad MBSW = MBSSSW$$

Those particular to the men's terminology are:

$$\begin{aligned} MB &= WBS = WMBSS = WMBDS & WyZ &= WBSD = MBSSD = WMBDSD \\ MBW &= WBSW = WMBSSW = WMBDSW & WyZH &= WBSDH = MBSSDH = WMBDSDH \\ MBS &= WBSS = WMBSSS = WMBDSS = WMBSSDH \\ MBSW &= WBSSW = WMBSSSW = WMBDSSW = WMBSSD \end{aligned}$$

The following are the corresponding women's equations:

$$\begin{aligned} F &= BS = MBDS & B &= BSS = MBSSS = MBDS = HFMB \\ M &= BSW = MBDSW & BW &= BSSW = MBSSSW = MBDSW = HFMBW \\ yZ &= BSD = MBDS & yZH &= BSDH = MBDSH \end{aligned}$$

The equations involving a woman's yZH elevate wife-takers perhaps because of the connection through her yZ, even though yZH falls logically in ego's own husband's line and should therefore be lowered.

The women's terminology contains eight equations not found in the men's terminology:

$$\begin{aligned} MBS &= FF & HMBSS &= F & HMBSSS &= B & HMBSSD &= yZ \\ MBSW &= FM & HMBSSW &= M & HMBSSSW &= BW & HMBSSDH &= yZH \end{aligned}$$

The first correspond to the use of *pahompu na mulak* in male ego's own generation (FFZDC and their spouses). The others refer to a woman's BS (HMBSS = BS according to the prescription). B = HFMB and BW = HFMBW require explanation because they appear to contradict the pattern of elevating wife-givers. One possible explanation is that these individuals are thought of as belonging to their husband's line (and thus wife-takers) even though they fall logically in their natal line. This does not seem to hold for other features, such as the elevation of HMBSS to F, in spite of a connection through ego's husband. That there are no vertical equations which apply to a woman's ascending generation relatives in her natal line or her mother's seems to support defining these individuals as wife-takers. The application of *iboto na mulak* and *eda na mulak* to HFMB and HFMBW is also anomalous in that they are the only terms applied both upwards and downwards.

Although the number of equivalences applied to wife-givers is larger, a complete list must also include those which refer to wife-takers or ego's own line. Those for a male speaker are:

$$\begin{aligned} FFZ &= Z & FFZD &= ZD & FFZDC &= ZDC & FFZDSW &= ZDSW & WFFZ &= WoZ \\ FFZH &= ZH & FFZDH &= ZDH & FFZDDH &= ZDDH & WFFZH &= WoZH \end{aligned}$$

Corresponding women's equations which refer to their husband's line or to that of their wife-takers are FFZ = oZ and HFFZ = HZ.

The significance of the vertical equations is that, with the few exceptions noted above, wife-giver positions are raised by the application of terms from two generations above, whereas those for wife-takers and ego's own line are lowered by terms from two levels below. Because terms from other generations are used to reinforce alliance status, a situation in which the same terms are applied both upwards and down-

wards is contradictory.

Exceptions to the application of the principle of alliance status are limited to the appearance of *maen* (and *anak*) in both ego's line and his wife's line in the first descending generation; the application of *ompung* and *pahomp* to more than one line in the second ascending and descending generations; the symmetric term for parents-in-law in the first ascending generation; and the symmetric women's term *eda* in ego's own generation.

Due to the symmetric term for parent-in-law, *simatua*, the following equations which are in accord with an asymmetric prescription do not hold: $MB = WF$, $MBW = WM$, $FZ = HM$ and $FZH = HF$. Instead, the Toba Batak terminology distinguishes *simatua* from *tulang*, *nantulang*, *namboru*, and *amangboru*. There are, however, indications that these categories are partially congruent because $BWF = MB$, $BWM = MBW$, $ZHM = FZ$, $ZHF = FZH$, HMB and $WFZH = F$, and WFZ and $HMBW = M$. The designation of male ego's WFFBS and WFFBSW as *tulang simatua* and *nantulang simatua* also supports the congruence of *tulang* and *simatua*. Ihromi's finding that an alternative term for male ego's *tulang na poso* (MBSS, WBS, etc.) is *simatua na poso* (Ihromi 1963:74), though not corroborated by my data, further strengthens the case. It is difficult to say why the term for parents-in-law has been differentiated from other affinal terms and why this symmetric feature appears in an otherwise asymmetric terminology. As Barnes (1980:373) states, with regard to the Karo Batak *impal*, there must be some reason for emphasizing symmetry if it exists in the terminology. In the case of *simatua*, it may be simply to stress that the husband's and wife's parents are equally deserving of the respect due to affines without negating their roles as closest representatives of wife-giving and wife-taking lines.

Alliance status is somewhat less emphasized in the women's terminology on ego's own level because of the symmetric term *eda*. *Eda* of the wife-givers and those of the wife-takers may, however, be distinguished by terms for husbands and by the address terminology. HZH and $FZDH$ are called *amang bao*, whereas B and $MBDH$ are called *iboto*; and HZ and FZD are addressed familiarly by name or teknonym, whereas BW and MBD must be addressed formally by *marga*, in accordance with the respect required by a woman toward her *iboto* as her wife-giver. Karo Batak reference terminology does distinguish between HZ (*beru* or *impal*) and BW (*eda*), but not between FZD and MBD (both *impal*) (Singarimbun 1975; Needham 1978). The men's address terminology in ego's own level contains a similar feature – the symmetric term *lae*. Asymmetry is maintained, though, by the reference terminology which distinguishes WB and MBS (*tunggane*) from ZH and FZS (*lae*).

It may be concluded that although there are certain symmetric features in the Toba Batak terminology, they are overridden by asymmetric indications. In the case of *maen*, *parumaen*'s more narrow application

clarifies alliance status. *Anak* is only problematical because of its association with *maen*. Alliance status may be specified in the second ascending and descending generations, in spite of the wider application of *ompung* and *pahompu*, by the application of terms from other generations. There is evidence that *simatua* is congruent with MB and MBW or FZ and FZH, and there are means of distinguishing the two kinds of *eda* and *lae*.

The marking of alliance status is achieved in the terminology in one of two ways – by the application of either specific terms or terms from another generation. This is best shown by comparing men's and women's terms for wife-givers of wife-givers and wife-takers of wife-takers in ego's own generation. Since a man's female wife-givers of wife-givers and a woman's male wife-takers of wife-takers, whom they might presumably think of marrying since such a marriage would not result in a reversal of an alliance, are distinguished by specific terms which indicate that marriage is precluded (*bao* and *boru ni tulang so sionion*), it is not necessary to further mark them by the application of terms from another generation to emphasize alliance status. A man's female wife-takers of wife-takers and a woman's male wife-givers of wife-givers, however, are marked as unmarriageable (it would reverse the direction of the alliance) either by *iboto* or by the application of alternate terms from another generation, lowering the former and raising the latter.

There is no shift in the women's terminology from terms based on alliance status to those based on relative age as in Kédang (Barnes 1974:279). Rather, as in Rindi, the distinction of alliance is just as extensive as in the men's but with different implications (Forth 1981: 318). A Toba Batak woman uses the same terms for her mother's line as her husband does, with the exception of *inang na poso* for her BSW. The tendency in Kédang (Barnes 1974:279) towards a loss of involvement with the alliance relation traced through a woman's MB and BWB after a generation also does not hold for the Toba Batak. MBS and BWBS are elevated to *tulang na poso* and MBSS to *iboto na mulak*, firmly labeling them as wife-givers. It is true, however, that ties entirely through women are eventually forgotten.

Sex as a principle of classification is applied in twenty of the men's terms and seventeen of the women's. Of those terms in which sex is not distinguished, *angkang*, *anggi*, *ompung*, *simatua*, and *haha* may indicate sex with auxiliary terms. Because there is no counterpart of *angkang pariban* or *anggi pariban* for a woman speaker, a woman's use of *doli* is wider than a man's (it indicates not only her ZH, but also her HB). A woman's HoB and HFoBS and their wives may be referred to as *haha*, based on the traditional avoidance between a man and his yBW, which extends to the address of yBW as *inang* to enforce distance and formality and the discouragement of marriage with yB's widow (Vergouwen 1964: 183). Only *bere* and *pahompu* are not distinguished by sex, perhaps

because these denote descending generation categories which are already inferior to ego on that basis, making it unnecessary to further differentiate them by sex (Forth 1981:316). This argument appears to be contradicted by the specifications of sex in nine terms used in descending genealogical levels (*tulang na poso*, *nantulang na poso*, *tunggane na mulak*, *inang bao na mulak*, *maen*, *parumaen*, *hela*, *boru*, and *anak*) but, if we exclude the terms applied from a higher level and those which are sex-specific only because of their status as sons' and daughters' spouses, only *anak* and *boru* remain as descending generation terms which specify sex. In contrast, in ascending generations or in ego's own level sex is, or can be, specified in all cases. *Pariban*, *bao*, and *iboto* specify sex within either the men's or women's terminology by classifying opposite-sex individuals in ego's own generation into three categories based on alliance status: the prescribed category for marriage, non-marriageable men's wife-givers of wife-givers or women's wife-takers of wife-takers, and non-marriageable siblings.

Relative age and the order of marriage are relevant in only four categories: *angkang*, *anggi*, *amang*, and *inang*. Relative age is significant between ego and his/her own or parents' same-sex siblings. In the case of *angkang* and *anggi*, distinctions may be made according to the relative ages of either the linking relatives or ego and the referent. This provides scope for alternative applications. The term *ampara* may be used to avoid uncomfortable categorical age distinctions between male *angkang* and *anggi*.

The order of marriage assigns an age difference between opposite sex individuals to determine the application of the terms *angkang* and *anggi* to ego's *pariban*'s spouse and to the children of ego's parents' *pariban* and the terms *amangtua*, *amanguda*, *inangtua*, and *inanguda* to ego's parents' *pariban*. For example, ego's *pariban*'s spouse would be *angkang* if the *pariban* marries before ego, or *anggi* if ego marries first. If a woman's MFZS married before her mother, she would call her MFZSD *angkang*. If her mother married earlier, MFZSD would be *anggi*. MFZS would be called *amangtua* if he preceded ego's mother in marriage but *amanguda* if he followed her. In practice, however, informants tended to use *amang* (and *inang*), ignoring the distinctions produced by the order of marriage.

There is one difference in the application of the principles of relative age and order of marriage when the women's terminology is compared to the men's in the first ascending generations. Those whom the one differentiates by their age relative to that of the parents, the other calls *simatua* (which makes no age distinctions).

TABLE VII: COMBINATION OF ALTERNATE GENERATIONS*

	Woman's Wife-takers		Woman's Wife-takers		Woman's Line of Origin		Woman's Wife-givers	
	f	m	f	m	f	m	f	m
+2	-eda	-bao	-eda	-angkang	-angkang	-iboto	-eda	ompung
+1						amang	inang	tulang
+0	eda	bao	eda	angkang anggi	angkang anggi	iboto	eda	iboto -(ompung)
-1						-(amang)	-inang	-tulang
-2				-anggi	-anggi	-iboto	-eda	-iboto

	Man's Wife-takers		Man's Patriline		Man's Wife-givers		Man's Wife-givers of Wife-givers	
	f	m	f	m	f	m	f	m
+2	-iboto	-lae	-iboto	-angkang pariban	-angkang pariban			
+1	-(bere)					tulang	nantulang	tulang
+0	iboto -(pahompu)	lae	iboto	angkang p. anggi p.	angkang p. anggi p.	tunggane	bao	tunggane
-1	bere					-tulang	-nantulang	-tulang
-2	pahompu			-anggi pariban	-anggi pariban	-tunggane	-bao	-tunggane

* Alternative terms in parentheses; hyphen denotes application of term to generation other than its focus.

Table VII allows us to compare the application of the principle of the combination of alternate generations by superimposing the men's and women's reference terminology, and shows how the pattern of alternation and alliance status reinforce each other. This approach provides a more complete understanding of the prominent feature of alternation. For example, the men's wife-givers' terminology shows four positions marked by terms from another generation. We should find that these terms correspond to terms in a woman's line of origin. Table VII demonstrates that a man's *angkang pariban* corresponds to his wife's *angkang*, his *anggi pariban* is her *anggi*, his *tulang* is her *amang*, and his *tunggane* is her *iboto*. There is, however, the problematic application of *iboto* both upwards and downwards in the women's terminology which constitutes an additional instance of the application of a term to another level. A woman's wife-givers (her mother's line) show six positions marked by terms from another level (including the application of *eda* both upwards and downwards), but only four for the men's terminology. There are four positions in the men's terminology for wife-takers to which terms from another level are applied, but only two in the corresponding women's line. Three terms are applied to a generation other than their focus in the women's wife-takers, and similar applications occur in the corresponding men's line. We can conclude that there is more divergence between the two terminologies in external lines than in ego's line or that of ego's spouse.

A comparison of terms used for their own line shows that four positions in the women's terminology are marked by terms from other generations compared to only three in the men's. A man's wife-takers exhibit four terms applied from another generation, whereas a woman's show only three, and a woman's wife-givers show six positions so marked compared to four for a man's. Based on an examination of conformity to the pattern of alternating generations in these three lines, it appears that in the women's terminology there is a slight simplification of the lineal dimension compared to the men's terminology.

The relationship between alternate generations and alliance status is clearly shown by Table VII. In the right half of the table, containing wife-givers and a woman's line of origin, the preponderant effect is the raising of terms, whereas the reverse is true in the left side, containing wife-takers and a man's own line. The relationship between alternation and alliance status is further developed by comparing the men's and women's terminologies with respect to the number of terms used to raise and lower status and the number of positions affected. In the men's terminology five terms raise status (*anggi pariban*, *bao*, *tulang*, *nan-tulang*, and *tunggane*) and five lower status (*iboto*, *lae*, *angkang pariban*, *bere*, and *pahompu*), whereas in the women's terminology five raise status (*anggi*, *amang*, *inang*, *tulang* and *ompung*) two lower status (*angkang* and *bao*), and two do both (*iboto* and *eda*). One more position is

raised than lowered in the men's terminology compared to two in the women's. This finding is supported by examining the lines individually. The woman's wife-takers of wife-takers are lowered less than her husband lowers his wife-takers or raises his wife-givers of wife-givers and a man raises the status of his wife-givers more than a woman lowers the status of her wife-takers. This affirms the subordinate position of a woman not only to her own parents and wife-givers but also to her husband's parents, who assume jural authority over her upon marriage. The identification of a woman with her husband's line is underlined by the use of the term *boru* to refer to both. Several other Indonesian languages, including Atoni (Cunningham 1965), Wailolong (Barnes 1977), and Manggarai (Needham 1966b), also use the same term for wife-taker and female.

While there are no instances in which a shift in status in one terminology, resulting from the application of terms from another generation, is contradicted in the other, there are instances where status shifts are not corroborated. HFMB and HFMBW are lowered in the women's terminology, but not in the men's; the women's terminology does not lower FFZD, FFZDS, and FFZDD as the men's does; and the men's terminology does not raise BS as the women's does. This shows that although the men's and women's terminologies make a slightly different use of the combination of alternate generations to reinforce alliance status, they are not contradictory, and the same net effect obtains.

In general, address terminology affirms the principles of classification exhibited by the reference terminology. Individuals characterized by greater age, higher genealogical level, and superior alliance status are usually addressed by forms marked with respect, whereas those of inferior generation, age, and alliance status may be addressed with familiarity. The principle of equating alternate generations is applied with the exception of parental teknonymy and the assignment of *inang* and *ito* in certain cases to an adjacent generation. Alliance status is maintained except in the case of the symmetric term *lae* and some applications of *amang* and *inang*.

Conclusions

The aims have been to describe the Toba Batak terminology and correct inadequacies in previous reports, to confirm the major features of the terminology, and to examine the operation of the principles of classification.

The Toba Batak men's and women's terminologies have been shown to verify lineality, patrilineal descent, asymmetric prescription, and the requirement of five lines. Because women are identified with wife-takers but originate from a wife-giving line, the distinction between the two in the women's terminology becomes muddled. The conclusion is that the men's and women's terms are complementary and that most of the

differences can be accounted for by simply considering a woman's different position in an asymmetric system. A comparison of address and reference terms is also instructive in comparing differences in ego's own generation. It is found that, whereas opposite-sex terms clearly label alliance status, the same-sex categories are found to be symmetric in the women's reference terminology and the men's address terminology but distinguished in the women's address and men's reference terms.

It has been demonstrated that the terms of reference and address are not congruent and that some address terms cover wider specifications than the corresponding reference terms. Address by name, teknonymy, and *marga* is shown to apply to own or lower generations and to denote either familiarity or formality.

Five principles of classification are found to characterize the terminology: genealogical level, alliance status, sex, age, and order of marriage. It has been demonstrated that generation is deemphasized by the application of almost half the reference terms on multiple levels. Alternate generations are equated to reinforce alliance status not only by raising wife-giving lines, but also by lowering wife-takers and one's own line. This is significant because, although other terminologies use genealogical level to reinforce alliance status, its occurrence in the line of reference as well as in external lines and its pervasiveness make the Toba Batak terminology unique. Correspondence in the men's and women's terminologies are used to explain the combination of alternate generations. The women's terminology is found to be slightly less elaborated than the men's on the lineal dimension. Overall, the features of the terminology which fail to distinguish wife-givers and wife-takers are shown to be qualified by symmetric features, and the lateral dimension is found to be much more elaborated than the lineal. Sex distinction are shown to be important in ego's own generation and the first ascending generation. Relative age and order of marriage both assign age distinctions – either between same-sex or opposite-sex individuals. It is shown that whereas categorical distinctions of genealogical level, alliance status, and sex must be expressed, age distinction may be avoided by use of an alternative term.

The significance of these findings is that another prescriptive terminology has been provided for the study of asymmetric prescriptive alliance which is especially appropriate for comparison with the terminologies of the Karo Batak and societies in eastern Indonesia. The articulation of alternation with patrilineality and alliance status in the Toba Batak terminology documents a particular exploitation of the lineal and lateral dimensions of classification which will be valuable in the discussion of relationship terminologies as systems of classification.

NOTES

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- 2 This figure is only an estimate since statistics on ethnic affiliation have not been published in Indonesia since 1935.
- 3 I used seven informants (three female and four male) consistently for the elicitation of kinship terminology, but checked this data repeatedly with other informants.
- 4 The "Toba area", not to be confused with "Toba Batak", refers to a subregion of the Toba Batak homeland and the area of origin of a Toba Batak subgroup. There are four subregions (Toba – the southeastern edge of Lake Toba and the area around Balige, Laguboti, and Porsea; Humbang – the area southwest of the lake around Dolok-sangul and Siborong-borong; Silindung – the area south of Humbang in the Silindung Valley, around Tarutung; and Samosir – the island in Lake Toba, and the area around Parapat on the "mainland"), each characterized by slight differences in language and culture. In Medan, one finds Toba Batak from each area. Kinship terminology tends to be of two types, characterized by some differences in usage. These are Silindung – Humbang and Toba – Samosir. The distribution of informants by area was three from Silindung (two male, one female), two from Toba (one male, one female), and two from Samosir (one male, one female).
- 5 Among the Toba Batak, the woman herself is not referred to as *hulahula*. This would conflict with the principle that male is superior to female and the idea that a woman is identified with her wife-takers.
- 6 Fischer's implication that *na poso* and *mangulahi* are synonymous is misleading. *Na poso* may only be used with reference to generations below or on the same level as ego's own, whereas *mangulahi* may be used on any level.
- 7 Only true if prescribed marriage actually takes place. If not, MBD $\neq$ BW (*pariban* $\neq$ *anggi boru* or *angkang boru*).
- 8 Older/younger designation depends on the order of marriage. The one married earlier will be called *angkang*, the one married later *anggi*.
- 9 Only true if prescribed marriage actually takes place. Otherwise ZS $\neq$ DH (*bere* $\neq$ *hela*).
- 10 Only true if prescribed marriage actually takes place. Otherwise MBSD = WBD (*maen*) but MBSD $\neq$ SW (*maen* $\neq$ *parumaen*).
- 11 To understand the confusion, it is best to work out the informants' rationale for defining the category *boru ni tulang so siolion*. Although she is the daughter of a *tulang*, marriage with her is prohibited because she is from the wife-givers of wife-givers and is ego's WB's *pariban*. It would be inappropriate for ego to marry her in spite of the fact that ego's mother calls her *maen*, classifying her as a potential wife for her son. From the perspective of female ego, FFZDS is classified as *amang bao* (with whom marriage is prohibited) in spite of the fact that her mother calls his FZDS *bere*, a category which includes potential sons-in-law. Since WFMBS and WMMBDD are unequivocally classified as ego's WB's *pariban*, ego's FMBSD and MMBDD should be classified as his own *pariban*, although some informants classified them as *boru ni tulang so siolion*. FMBSD was clearly classified as *tulang* and MMBD as *nantulang*, which would equally support classification of their daughter as *pariban* or *boru ni tulang so siolion*. Female informants agreed that a woman's FFZSS and MFZDS should be classified as her *pariban*. Since *pariban* is a reciprocal term, male ego should call his MMBDD and FMBSD *pariban*. Some informants classified FMBDD as *boru ni tulang so siolion*,

whereas others insisted on *iboto*. Clarification results from female ego's perspective. Her MFZSS is classified as *iboto* and, since this is a reciprocal term, a man's FMBDD should also be *iboto*.

- 12 Only true if prescribed marriage actually takes place. Otherwise, FZS $\neq$ ZH (*pariban* $\neq$ *angkang doli* or *anggi doli*).
- 13 Older/younger designation depends on order of marriage. The one married earlier will be called *angkang*, the one married later *anggi*.
- 14 Only true if prescribed marriage actually takes place. Otherwise, BD $\neq$ SW (*maen* $\neq$ *parumaen*).
- 15 Only true if prescribed marriage actually takes place. If not, FZDS = HZS (*bere*), but FZDS $\neq$ DH (*bere* $\neq$ *hela*).
- 16 She also states that this equation holds for male ego as well, which is not consistent with my data.

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